



# **Examination Report**

## **Fashion and Fabrics**

### **6904**

**EGCSE**

**2025**

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**Paper 6904/01**  
**Theory**

**General Comments**

There was a great improvement in terms of scores obtained by candidates compared to last year's paper. Some candidates were scoring very high marks, and it was indeed impressive to observe such in this subject. A very few candidates scored a single digit in this paper.

Most candidates did not fill in the grid on the cover page, indicating the questions they had selected, whereas it is a requirement expected of candidates.

Some candidates still answer all questions in Section B, whereas the instruction is to choose only two. Some candidates answer only one question in Section B. Some candidates do not answer Section C at all.

There was a strange observation in this year's paper where candidates would answer questions using a pencil instead of a pen. Some would start with a pencil and then overwrite with a pen without erasing the pencil.

**Section A**

All candidates attempted Section A, and this section proved to be more accessible to most candidates than the other two sections.

**Question 1**

**(a) Candidates were required to identify the style features indicated on the shirt in fig. 1**

The question was well attempted. Most of the candidates showed great improvement in identifying the style features. Candidates had challenges in identifying style features A, D, and E. They were giving wrong answers, like a flat collar for A, a cuff for D, and a button and buttonhole for E.

**The expected answers were as follows**

- A.** [roll /shirt] collar
- B.** [puffed/gathered/ set in/ short] sleeve
- C.** sleeve hem/ top stitching/ hem
- D.** yoke
- E.** buttons [and loops] / rouleaux /loops

**(b) Candidates were required to state two reasons for using a fabric made from silk fibres to make the dress in Fig. 1**

This question was well answered by most candidates. The common wrong answers were: it is a poor conductor of heat.



**(f) (i) Candidates were required to identify the piece of equipment shown in Fig. 3**

The candidates easily answered this question, and they got it correct.

**The expected answer was.**

(i) Ironing board

**(ii) The question required candidates to explain two factors to consider when buying/selecting the piece of equipment shown in Fig 3.**

The question was fairly answered by most candidates, although some did not explain the points to score full marks. Common wrong answers were consider the amount of space and money you have, the ironing board must have a warranty.

**The expected answers were as follows:**

- Adjustable – for use at different heights
- Have a padded surface – to make ironing/pressing easy
- Foldable – for easy storage/ minimize storage space
- Have a detachable cover that does not burn easily – make it easy to keep clean and does not burn easily.
- Have a heatproof stand - for placing a hot iron
- Strong and durable – so that it lasts longer
- Stable – to prevent accidents/for easy ironing

**(g) Candidates were required to draw the care symbols for hot iron and dry iron:**

The candidates had difficulties in responding to this question; a lot of them were trying to draw the iron instead of the ironing symbol. Another common mistake was to draw the symbols in squares or boxes first, which changed the meaning because a square is a symbol for drying.

**The expected symbols were:**

**Care symbols**

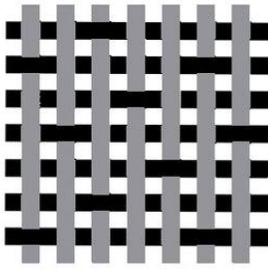
(i) Hot iron



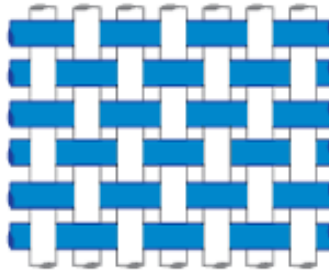
(ii) Dry clean



**(h) Candidates were required to identify the weaves shown in Fig. 4 and 5.**



**Fig. 4**



**Fig. 5**

Most answers were satisfying, although some students couldn't identify the weaves. Common wrong answers were twill weave for satin weave.

**The expected answers were:**

- (i) Fig. 4----- satin weave**
- (ii) Fig. 5 ----- Plain weave**

**(i) The question required the candidates to state three points to consider when choosing children's clothes.**

The candidates answered this question with ease. Some common wrong responses were avoid buying bright coloured clothes because they will get dirty and consider the sex of the child. The clothes should be warm or cold without specifying the season, such as warm for winter and cool for summer.

**The expected answers were:**

- Durability/ hardwearing/ strong/ withstand frequent washing
- Easy to wash/ washability
- does not soil easily
- Room for growth
- Easy to put on and off/ appropriate fastenings for a child/ design/ style
- They should be comfortable to wear/ fabric should stretch
- color
- warm in winter/ cool for summer
- type of fabric/lightweight for ease of movement

**(j) Candidates were required to explain how to remove a candle wax stain on a garment.**

**The candidates gave very good answers and in a logical order.**

Candidates had a great challenge with the word 'scrape', they were writing strange words like scrub, scrup, some say rub the stain. Some forgot to mention the water temperature for washing. Other common wrong answers were to put paper or carbon paper over and under the stain.

**The expected answers were:**

- scrape off wax using a blunt knife – to remove excess wax
- place brown/absorbent paper over and under the stain/ absorbent paper on top - for easy absorption of wax
- press with a hot/ warm iron- to melt the wax
- wash using warm/ hot soapy water – for wax to dissolve easily

**(k) Candidates were required to justify the following statements when using non- woven interfacing on parts of a garment.**

Almost all the candidates could not answer this question correctly. They explained the steps for attaching a non-woven interfacing. Some candidates seem not to understand the word 'justify.' Their responses were yes or no.

**The expected answers were:**

- (i) Non-woven bonded interfacing is economical** – it does not have warp and weft / it has no grainline, so it can be cut in any direction.
- (ii) Non-woven bonded interfacing is suitable for most fabrics** – it is available in different weights and colours

**(l) Candidates were required to explain how the application of the following finishes improves fabric performance and give one example for each.**

Very few candidates were unable to answer this question, although some left blank spaces. Some wrote Star Soft as an example instead of the fibre where the fabric **finish is used**.

**The expected answers were as follows:**

- (i) Weighting** – process applied to restore weight when the natural gum is removed (degumming)  
e.g silk

**Or**

**Sizing** – to retain freshness/crispness to handle, e.g., cotton, linen

- (ii) Anti-static-** reduces static charge/ reduces accumulation of static electricity/dust/dirt / does not cling to other fabrics and body during wear, e.g., polyester, silk, nylon, acrylic, polyamide, acetate, triacetate, tricot, crepe, Vilene.

## **SECTION B**

### **Question 2**

**(a) The question required the candidates to state the main classifications of man-made fibres.**

This question proved to be difficult for candidates. It was fairly attempted by most candidates. Common wrong answers were natural fibres, cotton.

**The expected answers were:**

- Regenerated fibres / Non-thermoplastic fibres
- Synthetic fibres / Thermoplastic fibres

**(b) (i) Candidates were required to give one function of the following sewing machine parts.**

This question was fairly answered by most candidates. Although some were leaving blank spaces. Common wrong answers were to repeat the words. Where a candidate would write that a feed dog feeds fabric into the machine.

**The expected answers were:**

1. **Feed dog** – pushes the fabric forward or backward during sewing/moves the fabric while sewing
2. **Presser Foot**– holds fabric firmly in position while sewing.
3. **Spool pin** – hold the reel of thread when sewing/ when threading the bobbin

**(ii) Candidates were required to state the advantages of using a sewing machine instead of hand sewing.**

Most candidates were able to answer this question. A common wrong answer was that a sewing machine sews straight stitches and has all the stitches.

**The expected answers were;**

- Faster
- Can choose from a range of different stitches
- More accurate
- Neater/ professional stitching
- Stronger stitches

**(Any two correct points)**

**(c) Candidates were required to define the following textile terms.**

This question was fairly attempted by candidates, although they gave incomplete answers.

**The expected answers were as follows:**

**Bonding** – two or more fabrics are fused by an adhesive to make a fabric/sticking two pieces of fabric together with a layer of foam in between them results in a bulky, warmer, and heavier fabric.



**Felting** - the process by which natural fibres (wool, cotton, and acrylic) shrink, coil, and lock when heat, moisture, friction, and pressure are applied or when fibres are pressed together using heat, moisture, and pressure to make a fabric. Matting fibres together under heat and pressure.

**Fabric finish** – treatment/process given to fabrics used to change the feel, appearance, and performance of the fabric.

**(d) The question required the candidates to explain how tertiary colours are made and give one example of a tertiary colour.**

A lot of candidates know that tertiary colours are formed by mixing a primary colour with a secondary colour, but they forgot to mention the 'neighbouring secondary colour.

**The expected answers were:**

**Tertiary colours** - a mixture of a primary colour with a neighbouring secondary colour on a colour wheel.

**Examples:**

Yellow + Green = Yellow-green = chartreuse/ spring green

Blue + Green = Blue green = turquoise/teal

Red + Violet = Red-violet = violet magenta

Red + Orange = Red-orange = vermillion

Yellow + Orange = Yellow-orange = amber

Blue + purple = blue- violet = violet

**(e) (i) Identify a self- neatening seam suitable to use on a lightweight fabric.**

The question was well attempted. Candidates were giving wrong answers, like plain seam.

**The expected answer was:**

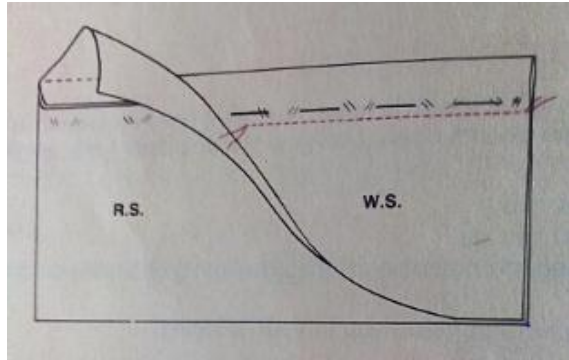
- French seam

**(ii) Candidates were required to give step by step instruction on how to make the seam in question 2 (e) and use labelled diagrams.**

This question showed a great improvement in how candidates answer application questions. Very few candidates mentioned tacking the seam 5mm above the stitching line. Some joined right sides together instead of wrong sides. Almost all the candidates remembered to press the seam. Some did not label the diagrams.

**The expected answers were:**

- With W.S. together, match notches and raw edges.
- Pin and tack 10mm from the raw edge/ 5mm above the stitching line
- Machine stitch on the stitching line.



- Remove tacking
- Trim seam to 6mm and press
- Turn R.S. together.
- Pin and tack on F.L.
- Remove pins and machine stitch on the stitching line.
- Press the seam towards the back of the garment

**Question 3**

**(a) Candidates were required to identify two methods of transferring pattern markings.**

Candidates were able to answer this question, although some gave incomplete answers, like tracing a wheel.

**The expected responses are:**

- Tailor's tacking / Thread mark
- Tracing wheel and tailor's carbon paper/tracing wheel and carbon paper
- Tailor's chalk/ pencil

**(b) The question required the candidates to state how each of the following machine faults can be corrected:**

Very few candidates were able to state the correct answer. A common wrong answer was that the sewing machine had not been threaded correctly.

**The expected answers were as follows:**

- (i) Skipped stitches – thread needle correctly/ use a sharp needle/correct size of needle/insert needle correctly/ do not pull fabric when sewing.
- (ii) Seams pucker- correct upper thread tension/use the correct size of thread for Fabric/wind bobbin evenly

**(c) (i) Candidates were required to state two types of facings.**

This was the most difficult question for the candidates. Common wrong answers were woven interfacing and no-woven interfacing.

**The expected answers are:**

- Extended facing
- Shaped facing
- Straight facing
- Binding: crossway strip and commercial

**(ii) Candidates were required to explain two ways to ensure that a facing stays in the correct position.**

Only a few candidates mentioned under-stitching and could not explain it. Common wrong responses were to press the facing so that it lies flat.

- Facing needs to be understitched – so it won't roll to the R.S.
- Apply catch stitches to sew the facing to the shoulder/side seams

**(d) (i) Candidates were required to describe two types of collars and give one example for each.**

Most of the candidates knew the types of collars, but they could not describe them. Some gave correct examples of the collars.

**The expected answers were:**

- (i) Flat collar** – this collar emerges from the neckline seam and lies flat on the garment. It is mainly found on children's clothes, e.g., Peter Pan, sailor's collar.
- (ii) Roll collar** – stands up from the neck edge, then falls to rest on the garment, e.g. shawl collar/ shirt collar
- (iii) Stand collar** – it extends above the neckline of the garment either as a narrow single band or a wider double-width band that will fold back down on itself, e.g., mandarin/ Chinese collar.

**(e) Candidates were required to describe how to finish the waistline of a cotton poplin skirt using an elasticated casing.**

This question was poorly answered by most candidates. Most of them were attaching interfacing and attaching a waistband. A fair number of them remembered to insert the elastic in the casing.

**The expected answers were:**

- Fold 5mm/ neaten the raw edge at the waistline to the wrong side
- Fold a sufficient width of the casing, pin, and tack.
- Starting at the seam, machine stitch the lower edge of the casing to the wrong side of the garment, leaving a 2cm opening for inserting the elastic
- Machine stitch on the FL of the garment and the edge of the top fold.
- Insert the elastic into the casing using bodkin taking care it does not twist
- Overlap and pin the ends of elastic together and machine stitch square on the overlapped ends

- Machine stitch on the folded edge of the casing to close the opening  
**for applied casing:**
- double fold hem
- cut out casing
- Attach elastic
- Attach bodkin
- Stitching the elastic

**Question 4**

**(a) Candidates were required to identify the following machine stitches:**

- (i) 
- (ii) 
- (iii) 

Most candidates were able to identify the overlocking and zigzag stitches but failed to identify the herringbone stitch. They gave answers like cross-stitch. Although they were able to identify the zigzag stitch, the spelling was wrong.

**The expected answers were:**

- (i) Overlock Stitch
- (ii) Zig Zag Stitch
- (iii) Herringbone stitch

**(b) Candidates were required to identify three methods of embellishing/decorating garments.**

There was a wide range of responses given by candidates. Some lost marks by listing examples of embroidery stitches and trimmings. Other common wrong answers given were: giving examples of methods of disposing of fullness and mentioning printing and dyeing. Some candidates were writing using embroidery threads instead of embroidery stitches.

**The expected answers were:**

- (i) Embroidery/ decorative stitches
- (ii) Applique
- (iii) Using trimmings, e.g., lace, piping, rick-rack, ribbon, binding
- (iv) Beads
- (v) Sequins
- (vi) Patchwork
- (vii) Quilting

**(c) The question required the candidates to state the visual effect of the following designs on the silhouette.**

Candidates who chose this question were divided into two. Some understood it and scored all the marks, and some did not understand it. Common wrong answers were that bright colours are associated with a happy mood and make an object noticeable, and dull-textured fabrics are difficult to wash because they are heavy.

**The expected answers were:**

- (i) Large bold prints – make the figure look bigger/ fuller/ add weight
- (ii) Vertical lines – make the figure look taller and slimmer
- (iii) Bright colour – make figure fuller/ add weight
- (iv) Heavy textured fabric – makes the body appear heavy/bulky/ make figure bigger/looks fat

**(d) Candidates were required to define ‘mix and match’ and give one example of buying “mix and match” clothes.**

This question was not well answered by the candidates. They gave vague definitions. Common wrong answers were that mix and match, is combining clothes of different colours, and it is cheaper.

**The expected answers were:**

**Definition-** Several different garments may be worn in different combinations to create different looks.

- **Advantages-** give greater variety, enlarged wardrobe, save money, create uniqueness

**(e) Candidates were required to state how the following Eswatini traditional wear can be used to make a contemporary garment or accessory.**

Candidates did not understand this question. They explained how indlamu and umhelwane are worn.

**The expected answers are:**

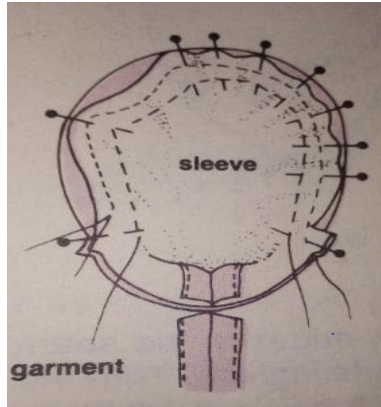
- **Indlamu** – make a dress/ skirt
- **Umhelwane** – a piece of umhelwane cloth could be made into a dress/ shirt/top/hat/ bag /use as decoration on garments/ accessories

**(f) The question required the candidates to explain how to attach a set in sleeve to the armhole of a garment and use labelled diagrams.**

This question was well done by most students, although they omitted the easing process. Candidates tried to draw diagrams, but they were not labelled.

**The expected responses were:**

- Determine the front and back of the sleeve
- With R.S. together, put the sleeve inside the armhole, matching the underarm seam with the side seams and sleeve head to the shoulder seam, always work with the sleeve on the uppermost.



- Match raw edges and notches
- Pull gathering/easing threads to distribute easing evenly
- Roll seam around fingers - Pin and tack on F.L
- Remove pins and machine stitch on F.L
- Neaten S.A., remove tacking and press.

## **SECTION C**

### **Question 5**

**The candidates were required to explain how fibres are produced and discuss the reasons for using fabrics from cotton fibres for summer clothing.**

This was a popular question in this section. Most candidates scored very high marks in this question. They were able to list and discuss the steps of cotton production. Although candidates failed to explain the reasons why cotton is suitable for summer wear. Some listed all the properties without relating them to summer wear. Also, they were not discussing the properties.

**The expected answer:**

Fibres are the basic components of textile fabrics. Knowing their origin and properties is important to enable you to handle them properly.

Cotton is obtained from the cotton plant; it bears delicate white flowers, which later become a fluffy mass of fibres surrounding the seed. The mass of fibres is called a ball. The fibres in each ball are of different lengths (5cm or less)

The following are the steps in the production of cotton fibres:

Picking bolls- bolls are picked when ready, they do not ripen at the same time and are harvested at intervals.

Ginning – bolls are put in a machine to remove seeds, stalks, leaves and other impurities.

Grading – the cleaned cotton is graded according to the fineness, length and strength of the fibres.

Scutching – machines remove all impurities/ tears fibres apart/ fibres converted into thick wads.

Carding – these machines remove remaining impurities, disentangle the fibres and arrange them in thick slivers. The fibres now lie parallel to each other.

Combing – slivers are combed to remove the short fibres. This also makes fibres thinner and longer.

Drawing – slivers are mixed, drawn and twisted to form threads called rovings.

Spinning – fibres are twisted to form yarns and are ready for weaving.

Dyeing – cotton fibres may be dyed, or dyeing may be done after weaving. (14 marks)

Reasons that make cotton suitable for summer wear.

Absorbent- readily absorbs moisture, good for sportswear.

Good conductor of heat – cool to wear in summer –good for summer clothes.

Strong and durable – to withstand frequent laundering.

Although fluffy, it can be treated to resist dirt

Easy to launder – does not need special care, therefore, cheap to maintain.

Mild alkalis such as soap and soap powders do not have a marked effect, but strong alkalis may cause cotton to turn yellow

| <b>BAND</b>                    | <b>DESCRIPTOR</b>                                                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>HIGH</b><br><b>14 – 20</b>  | -Discusses six or more steps in cotton production.<br>-Discusses six or more reasons for cotton.<br>-Shows understanding of the topic.<br>-Uses correct terminology.            |
| <b>MIDDLE</b><br><b>9 – 13</b> | -Discusses three or more steps in cotton production.<br>-Discusses three or more reasons of cotton.<br>-Shows some understanding of the topic<br>-Uses some correct terminology |
| <b>LOW</b><br><b>1 – 8</b>     | -Discusses one or no steps in cotton production.<br>-Discusses one or no reasons of cotton.<br>-Shows little understanding of the topic<br>-Uses little correct terminology     |

## **Question 6**

**Candidates were required to describe two methods of resist dyeing and should include the advantages and disadvantages of each method**

A few candidates chose this question. Some were able to describe the two methods of resist dyeing in full. Some discussed methods like potato printing, chemical dye, and natural dye.

Methods of resisting dying

### **Tie and dye:**

- Is done by tying tightly with a string or rubber bands on some parts of the fabric, which will not absorb the dye, whereas the parts that are not tied will absorb the dye.

- The fabric is then immersed in the dye bath for a few minutes and taken out
- Dry the fabrics with knots intact, and after drying
- Untie knots
- Further dry
- Repeat the same procedure if you want to apply another colour.
- Items needed when tie-dyeing: a string or rubber bands, fabric to be dyed, a bucket, masking tape, newspaper, and your dyes.

### **Advantages of tie-dye**

- Develops fine motor skills, visual skills, hand eye coordination
- Reduces stress
- Reduced cost of producing beautiful fabrics - use fewer chemicals and energy compared to other methods
- Relatively easy, flexible technique that accommodates any number of aesthetics
- You use synthetic dyes that have bright colours and are affordable
- Promotes creativity/ encourages creativity

### **Disadvantages**

- Takes time and effort
- Messy – you need to protect your clothes and wear gloves
- Dyes can have environmental and health risks

### **Batik**

-Uses wax to create colour designs on fabrics, parts of the fabric will resist the dye while the parts that have no wax will absorb the dye

- The fabric is bleached to remove natural colour and washed in hot water and detergent to remove chemicals and impurities/wash in hot soapy water.
- Dry it completely.
- Cover the working surface with newspaper.
- Draw design onto fabric



- Melt wax in a pan, then apply wax with a paint brush on parts that are to resist dye, starting at the centre. Cool wax to harden.
- Dip the fabric in the dye bath/ colour
- Hang on a line to dry
- Scrape off excess wax.
- Press the fabric to remove creases and wax, using newspaper underneath and on top of the fabric to absorb wax.
- Wash

Suitable fabric – cotton, wool, linen, and most man-made fabrics.

#### Advantages

- Improve hand-eye coordination
- Improves memory
- Relieves daily tension and stress
- Nurture creativity/ boost self-esteem/encourage self-expression
- Teaches flexibility
- It can allow one to include a variety of colours at once.

#### Disadvantages

- Lack of demand, therefore, not a lot of people buy
- Labour-intensive
- Takes a long time

| <b>BAND</b>              | <b>DESCRIPTOR</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>HIGH<br/>14 - 20</b>  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Stated the two methods of resist dyeing.</li><li>- Described how each method is applied.</li><li>- Stated reasons for the choice of each method.</li><li>- Stated the advantages of each method</li><li>- Stated the disadvantages of each method.</li><li>- Used correct terminology.</li></ul>                                     |
| <b>MIDDLE<br/>9 – 13</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Stated one of the resist dyeing.</li><li>- Describe some application each method is applied.</li><li>- Stated some reasons for the choice of each method.</li><li>- Stated some advantages of each method</li><li>- Stated some disadvantages of each method.</li><li>- Used some correct terminology.</li></ul>                     |
| <b>LOW<br/>1 - 8</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- No method of resist dyeing is stated</li><li>- States a vague description of how each method is applied.</li><li>- Stated a few reasons for the choice of each method.</li><li>- Stated a few of the advantages of each method</li><li>- Stated a few disadvantages of each method.</li><li>- Used very few correct terms.</li></ul> |

**Paper 6904/02**  
**Practicals**

## **Introduction**

A total of 1703 candidates registered for the year 2025, of whom 1690 were actual candidates, resulting in a low number of absentees (13 candidates) and an increase of 53 entries compared to last year, 2024. However, some centres showed a slight improvement in the quality of the work done on the garment. All required processes for the garments were well done. Most of the candidates still had difficulty relating reasons for their choices to themselves in the folder; those who gave good explanations outperformed the previous year cohort. This year, folders were marked externally.

## **Packaging and Presentation**

There has been a great improvement in the packing of the garments, folders, and paperwork this year. Only a very few centres pack garments separately, which makes it very difficult to find work for each candidate. Otherwise, almost all centres packed the garments well, as the folder per candidate and the paperwork in a separate envelope, which was commendable. Individual mark sheets should be packed in a separate envelope, not bundled in the folder.

## **Labelling**

This was done well by most candidates, but some candidates did not label their garments and folders, which should be discouraged. Some candidates sew their labels on double fabric, which is discouraged. A few candidates attached their labels using a single thread and did not secure the ends well, and these labels were coming out; some folders were not labeled at all. Those centres are urged to have their candidates' work labelled. All centres are still urged to label the ECESWA plastics accurately with all the necessary information, e.g., centre number and centre name. When a centre has two plastic bags, the labelling should indicate 1 of 2. Those using boxes should put paperwork in an envelope and then put it in the box.

## **Folder**

All the requirements for the folder were met by most candidates except for a few who had missing pictures. Most candidates were able to describe the garment in detail, with a few of them giving very brief explanations with an omission of some style features, such as the hem, pockets, and embellishment. The reasons for choices were well explained by a good number of the candidates, and they related to themselves. However, some candidates had reasons for their choice not relating to themselves. Most candidates had folders, even though some had incomplete ones; folders must be arranged in chronological order as per the syllabus. Some candidates had well-drawn, coloured, and labelled illustrations. Very few candidates did not label their illustrations. Some candidates mixed costs and a list of requirements. They also did not quantify the list of requirements, and those who did, however, calculated wrongly. Some included sewing equipment, which should be discouraged. Plans of work were done well, but most candidates wrote either too detailed or shallow plans of work instead of well-articulated summaries. This time around, three photos were to be included in the folder: one for layout, one for sewing processes, and the last one for fitting of the garment. Most centres had all the photos; a few had at least one photo present. Centres are encouraged to follow

syllabus well and encouraged to write on separate pages the different items. **Centres should avoid using plastic pocket files.**

### **Choice of Fabric for The Project**

There was a great improvement in the choice of fabric for the garment this year. However, some centres still had fabrics that gave the candidates challenges during sewing, like scuba, stretchy denim, and the final pressing of the garments. Candidates should be assisted in choosing fabrics that are easy to handle. Also, avoid too dark colours.

### **Garment**

In general, the garments were well done overall and had all the required processes for most candidates. However, a few candidates lacked one or two processes, i.e. Self-hem on the sleeve instead of sleeve band or cuff. A few used bindings on the hem. And a few candidates submitted unfinished garments. Most candidates this year made shirts and dresses for the garment.

### **MANIPULATION**

#### **Collars**

The collar was attached well by most candidates; their collars were trimmed, flat, and the collar points matched. However, a few had their collars bulky, not aligned, and out of balance. A few finished the collar using a crossway strip as binding instead of using it as a facing on the inside. All types of collars were observed: the roll collar, the flat, and the stand collar, as per the syllabus. The flat collar and roll collar challenged most candidates; it was not well aligned and not well finished.

#### **Sleeves**

Most candidates used set-in sleeves, and they attached the sleeves very well, except for those who used the flat method. The sleeves were mostly aligned well on the underarm seam, though some did not neaten the sleeve seam. Most candidates who went the extra mile to apply a placket on the sleeve edges of their shirts were well done, and those who did the bound opening had a challenge with the placement of the opening on the cuff. However, some candidates did not confine fullness to the head, but it was found in some cases almost at the underarm, indicating poor distribution.

#### **Control of Fullness**

The Garments for most candidates had single-pointed darts and double-pointed darts in the shirts and dresses, box and knife pleats, as they were mostly shirts and dresses. Some candidates used pin tucks on the shirts. The shirts with double-pointed darts worked well for most candidates, and there were a few cases where the darts were not positioned well, not tapered well, or not of an equal length. A few candidates made gathers for control of fullness for the dresses, and some of these were evenly distributed and well pressed.

## **Fasteners**

A variety of fasteners were found on the garments. Candidates made buttons and buttonholes, zippers, hooks and eyes, and press studs. These were done well by most candidates except for a few cases where a wrong hand stitch was used on the hooks and eyes, as well as the press studs. It was most preferred for those who used the hook and eye. The correct method of finishing or neatening the button should be used. The correct placing of the buttons and buttonholes at the centre front was done well by most candidates, and a few even made hand-worked shanks on their buttons and did them well. Covered buttons were also used by some candidates, and these were done well. The hand-worked buttonhole stitch was poorly done this year by some. Other candidates made vertical buttonholes on the collar bands instead of horizontal ones. The button band was folded and not joined by most candidates, and it was also well-stitched.

## **Sleeve band or cuff**

The sleeve band/cuff gave them challenges; it was not well aligned, and for some, it was twisted. For the band or the cuff, some centres used very thick interfacing. On the cuff or band, the opening should be at the back, not the front and should be of proper length, even though most centres make cuffs that are without a fastener for the long sleeve.

## **Pockets**

The most common pockets that were sewn were in seams and patch pockets. Most were challenged by the positioning of the pockets and the size, especially of the patch pocket. Candidates are urged to under-stitch and neaten the inseam pockets. Centres are urged to avoid the three-in-one pocket and be guided by the syllabus. The pocket that challenged them the most was the inseam pocket.

## **Embellishment**

Most candidates embellished their garments to an excellent standard as they used varied types of embellishment, e.g., motifs, piping, contrasting colours, ribbons, embroidery, appliqué, and trimmings. Some candidates embellished using embroidery stitches, which ended up being graded twice. There were those, however, who did low-quality stitches, and they seemed not well planned. Piping was also done, but not commonly this time around.

## **Seams**

Candidates generally used a plain seam (closed and open) and did mostly well, except for a few candidates whose widths were too wide. A few candidates used French and a flat fell method; these were also done well with good widths and straight stitching. For closed seams, the width of the seam was not well-neatened, and the size was too wide. Most centres failed to neaten curved areas, e.g., armhole seam, such that they were left with no neatening. There were some candidates who used zigzag and clean finish, and some centres used binding as a method of neatening seams.

## **Hems**

Most candidates had suitable hems for their garments, even on curved hems; a few had wide hems on curved hems, which made twisted and uneven widths. Most hems were machine-stitched on the shirts; some were finished using bias binding and done well. A variety of stitches were used for sewing the hem, e.g., hemming, slip hemming, blind hemming, and herringbone. A few candidates presented their garments without hems.

## **Machine Stitching Skills**

Very good machine stitching was done by most candidates, and the stitch length was suitable for most fabrics. There were fewer imbalances in the tension of the machines this year. The overlocker was still a challenge this year as the tension was loose, and sewing curved areas was also a challenge, and was inappropriately done by some candidates; some were affected by their choice of fabric. The sewing of straight stitches was improved this year.

## **Hand Sewing Skills**

A few candidates did excellent work on hand sewing skills; that is, they selected the stitches, and they were worked to a high standard. However, most of the candidates did not have a selection of stitches as the syllabus requires (both permanent and embroidery), using at least three or more. They had mostly one stitch repeated on different parts of the garment, e.g., hemming stitch on the cuff, collar, and on the hem edge. Some of the hem stitches were wide and loose, while some centres used double thread for hem stitches when they had to use a single thread. Some candidates used a single thread for embroidery, yet two or more strands are required. Candidates are encouraged to use a stabilizer where the embroidery is done; most centres observed this requirement, and to avoid the use of brand names when applying embroidery.

## **Reminders to Centres**

Individual assessment forms should not be included in the packaging but should be placed in a separate envelope with the summary assessment form and attendance register. Folders should not be marked by centers. Avoid using plastic pocket files in folders. Centers are advised to seek assistance from subject specialists at ECESWA whenever they face challenges related to coursework assessment, packaging, or any clarification needed on instructions sent to centers. They must not sample the garments. All individual marked sheets and summary sheets should be totaled, and registers should be completed thoroughly and submitted. Avoid using pins during packaging, as they are dangerous to examiners. Use appropriate columns when entering marks. Centers are encouraged to use blue pens when writing or filling in forms. Centers are advised to use simple patterns for all required processes and to stick to the syllabus. Avoid the use of arch lever files. Declaration forms must be included in the folder, signed and stamped by the Headteacher.

